

# Riseguide vs. Liven · Coursiv Headway

A side-by-side reputation benchmark across product quality, customer service, user feedback, billing transparency and brand trust · July 23, 2026

RISEGUIDE COMPOSITE

5.5<sub>/10</sub>

▲ +0.1

Mixed

#3 of 4 · Headway leads at 6.3

BIGGEST WIN THIS WEEK

Sentiment & platform consistency 5.5/10 · ▲ +0.5

COHORT COMPOSITE SCORES

RiseGuide

5.5<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.4 / 5 · Trustpilot  
17,950+ reviews

Liven

5.2<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Apple App Store  
49K iOS ratings

Coursiv

5.8<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Trustpilot  
119,000+ reviews

Headway

6.3<sub>/10</sub>

Watch

4.6 / 5 · Apple App Store  
115K iOS ratings

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · ALL DIMENSIONS

|           |                          | RISEGUIDE                                      | LIVEN                                          | COURSIV                                        | HEADWAY                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 01        | Product Quality          | <div><div></div></div> 7.2                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.7                     |
| 02        | Customer Service         | <div><div></div></div> 5.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.2                     |
| 03        | User Feedback            | <div><div></div></div> 6.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.8                     | <div><div></div></div> 8.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.6                     |
| 04        | Billing Transparency     | <div><div></div></div> 3.2                     | <div><div></div></div> 2.9                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.9                     |
| 05        | Brand Trust & Legitimacy | <div><div></div></div> 4.5                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| COMPOSITE |                          | <div>5.5<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.1</div> | <div>5.2<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>5.8<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>6.3<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> |

01

Product Quality

7.2/10

Headway leads this dimension at 7.7/10; RiseGuide sits at 7.2/10 (was 7.2 last week). Headway improved most this week (+0.5 vs. last week).



Marketing vs reality

| RISEGUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | LIVEN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | COURSIV                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | HEADWAY <span>LEADER</span>                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Watch · 6.5</div> <p>The 'it's really just AI content' jab has settled into a permanent low hum rather than a growing threat. It still surfaces on both stores and in video comments — one commenter this week shrugged that matching cards 'counts as brain training' — but it never dents the core: 65 of 100 App Store reviews and 62 of 100 Google Play reviews landed at five stars. The framing questions the brand's honesty, not the product's usefulness, so the score holds.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5</div> <p>Trustpilot still rewards the CBT wellness positioning, but app-store sentiment is slipping. Bug and slow-performance complaints are increasingly visible — marketed promise diverging from daily-use experience.</p> | <div>Mixed · 5.5</div> <p>Beginner-AI lessons land strongly with first-time users — earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster. Drag remains deceptive-advertising and pricing complaints from outside the funnel.</p> | <div>Healthy · 7</div> <p>Book-summary promise delivered consistently across both stores. Sentiment is net-positive and stable, no new complaint cluster, and YouTube creator coverage is unanimously positive.</p> |

Unique value proposition

**RISEGUIDE**

Healthy · 7.5

The structured-journey format is the one thing that strengthens no matter what else moves. Satisfied-user praise hit its highest level in the record this week — 102 App Store reviews and 37 Google Play reviews singled it out, averaging close to five stars — with 'genuinely helpful, easy to follow' still the densest positive theme anywhere in the data. While the two stores pulled in opposite directions on sentiment, the reason people love the product only deepened.

**LIVEN**

Watch · 6.5

The CBT-companion + mood tracker stack is coherent on paper, but reviewers split on whether the AI companion helps or distracts. The differentiator isn't fully landing.

**COURSIV**

Healthy · 7.5

Mobile-first AI skill tracks remain clearly differentiated from desktop video-course competitors. Product experience earned the cohort's most concentrated positive sentiment.

**HEADWAY**

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Category leader by every measure: scale, feature maturity, review-base depth. No meaningful movement on the differentiation story.

Accessibility & consistency

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.5

Flat from last week. The stability worry we'd tracked on the App Store finally reversed — bug mentions there fell from eight to five after two weeks of drift, and none carried the one-star fury that signals a real break. The only new wrinkle is on Google Play, where speed and performance complaints doubled to six at a middling 2.8-star average. That's a glance-worthy watch, not an alarm, and it's why the score holds rather than moves.

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LIVEN

Watch · 6

▲ +0.5

Aggregate ratings are decent, but the iOS bug cluster is the broadest in cohort relative to volume. ADHD/anxiety customisation gaps remain active.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive. We don't have visibility into iOS reviews because that app isn't in our tracking tool — this rating reflects Android only.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +1.5

Aggregate ratings remain strong with a small iOS-Android gap. Structural concern: the support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely. Product consistent; experience around it isn't.

## 02 Customer Service

5.8/10

**Coursiv** leads this dimension at **6.3/10**; RiseGuide sits at **5.8/10** (was 5.8 last week). All four brands held their dimension scores flat this week.

RiseGuide **5.8**Liven **4.0**Coursiv **6.3**Headway **5.2**

### Support channel availability

#### RISEGUIDE LEADER

##### Watch · 6

Coverage hasn't changed — email and the help portal still carry every conversation, with no live chat or phone line. The model holds while volume is steady, but it has no shock absorber: when billing anger concentrates on one store, the same single inbox absorbs all of it. The next improvement that would actually move this score is a tooling investment — a self-serve billing and cancellation flow — not another support hire.

#### LIVEN

##### Mixed · 4.5

Critical structural gap: the team engages actively on Android but doesn't reply to iOS reviews at all. The 'multi-channel support' claim doesn't hold on the largest store.

#### COURSIV LEADER

##### Watch · 6

Multi-tier support (email, portal, knowledge base) plus active engagement on visible channels. Less visibility on iOS — that app isn't in our tracking tool.

#### HEADWAY

##### Mixed · 5.5

Same iOS gap as Liven, newly visible: replies on Android but not iOS. Trustpilot's high reply rate was masking it — once Appbot iOS was added, the dead-zone surfaced.

### Response speed & quality

#### RISEGUIDE LEADER

##### Watch · 6.5

Support stayed visible for the right reasons this week. Customer service drew ten App Store mentions averaging 4.3 stars and three on Google Play averaging a perfect five — customers volunteering that the team is responsive and helpful rather than raising a problem. It's a reminder that when this team surfaces in reviews, it's usually because someone had a good experience. Speed of reply is a solved problem here; the unfinished work sits one criterion down.

#### LIVEN

##### Mixed · 4

Two-track operation: Android reviewers get steady engagement, iOS reviewers get nothing. Multi-week silence pattern reported by users is now confirmed as structural for iOS.

#### COURSIV LEADER

##### Watch · 6.5

Where visible, response density is excellent — every Android reviewer gets a reply, including every negative one. iOS visibility gap caps the read at watch-level.

#### HEADWAY

##### Mixed · 5.5

Same dual-track problem as Liven, exposed for the first time: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Previous high score was Trustpilot-only signal.

## Complaint resolution rate

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

**Flat from last week. The 'everyone hears back' promise held perfectly again — every negative review across the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot got a company reply. But answering still isn't closing. Google Play reviewers this week describe being charged 'at a higher charge than the first' with 'no chance to cancel,' and one says plainly they 'can't find a way to cancel the subscription.' The gap between a fast reply and a fixed problem is exactly where billing anger collects, and it hasn't narrowed.**

Every unhappy customer still gets a reply — every negative review on the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot drew a company response this week — but a reply still isn't a fix. Google Play billing reviews describe being charged 'at a higher charge than the first' with 'no chance to cancel,' and one customer 'can't find a way to cancel the subscription.'

Responsiveness is reliable; converting that reply into a resolved refund is where the billing anger keeps pooling.

### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + Android Appbot strong, but iOS reviews accumulate without any response. Refund and bug threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

100% reply to negative reviews on Trustpilot, but only 63.5% reply rate overall. Selective engagement — they answer negatives when they see them but skip a third of all reviews.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + 100% Android engagement, but iOS shows the same gap as response-speed: every negative iOS review is now ignored. Apple Communities refund-refusal threads remain active.

03

User Feedback

6.7/10

▲ +0.1

Coursiv leads this dimension at 8.1/10; RiseGuide sits at 6.7/10 (was 6.6 last week). Liven improved most this week (+0.7 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 6.7 ▲ +0.1

Liven 6.8 ▲ +0.7

Coursiv 8.1 ▲ +0.7

Headway 7.6 ▲ +0.5

Review volume & rating

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 8.3

▲ +0.1

Growth stayed broad and — for once — a rating moved up, not just sideways. Trustpilot added 615 reviews this week, a 2.7% increase, holding at 4.4 stars, and Google Play grew about 3.5% while its rating recovered from 4.1 to 4.2. The App Store passed 16,700 reviews at 4.6. When volume keeps rising this steadily and the softest store actually improves, it reads as genuine momentum rather than a solicitation push. The clean part of the picture got a little cleaner.

LIVEN

Healthy · 8.5

Strong cross-platform scale: 29,407 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.16, plus iOS / Android footprints. iOS sentiment meaningfully stronger than Android, but volume itself is meaningful at this scale.

COURSIV

Healthy · 8.5

Largest review base in cohort by a wide margin — 138,144 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.59, built up in under a year of operating. Heavily invited (98.0% prompted), but volume itself is a credibility asset.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Exceptional · 9

▼ -0.5

Largest absolute footprint in cohort: 6,493 Trustpilot reviews at ★3.93, plus 115K iOS + 169K Android reviews. Trustpilot rating is the weakest in cohort — 6+ years of accumulation surfaces real friction.

Sentiment & platform consistency

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.5

▲ +0.5

Up from last week. Last week's sliding store turned around. Google Play's negative sentiment nearly halved, its one-star reviews fell from eighteen to fourteen, and its five-star reviews jumped from thirty-four to sixty-two — pulling its rating back above 4.2. The App Store softened slightly in return, but the net move is clearly positive and it's the biggest genuine improvement anywhere in the report: the checkout anger that migrated to Google Play last week eased rather than deepened.

The store that was sliding last week reversed course. Google Play's negative sentiment nearly halved, its one-star reviews fell from eighteen to fourteen, and its five-star reviews jumped from thirty-four to sixty-two. The App Store softened mildly in the other direction — a few more one-star reviews — but the dominant move was Google Play's recovery, and satisfied-user praise grew on both stores. This is the biggest genuinely positive swing in the report this week.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

▲ +2.5

Sentiment consistently mediocre across stores — no managed-channel cushion. Fresh App Store sentiment slipped notably, confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +3.0

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive — but Reddit is the most negative in the cohort. Sharpest managed-versus-organic gap of any brand. iOS data not available.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▲ +2.5

iOS reads moderately positive; Android shows a near-tie between positive and negative. Fresh App Store reviews were notably worse than baseline — the worst fresh signal in the cohort.

Review authenticity signals

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.8

Flat from last week. The number that structurally caps this dimension didn't move. About 98% of Trustpilot reviews this week still came from company invitations, and the single compliance flag is a routine billing information-request, not a fraud claim. The independent tracker RealReviews held steady at 4.5 stars. Nothing worsened — but nothing resolved the core question either: a near-perfect average built almost entirely on solicited reviews is only as convincing as the organic core the company can prove exists.

The number that structurally caps this dimension didn't move. About 98% of Trustpilot reviews this week still came from company invitations, and the single compliance flag is a routine billing information-request, not a fraud allegation — the same benign picture as last week. The independent tracker RealReviews held steady at 4.5 stars. Nothing worsened, but nothing resolved the core question either: a near-perfect average built almost entirely on solicited reviews.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

94.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — heavier solicitation than RiseGuide but lighter than Coursiv. The iOS reply silence means iOS reviews accumulate untouched — technically more organic on that store, but also a sign of disengagement.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

98.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — the heaviest solicitation pattern in the cohort. Massive volume (138K reviews) counterbalanced by a meaningfully positive organic Reddit signal. Volume is the credibility asset; authenticity is the question mark.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Only 44.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — by far the most organic profile in the cohort. Six-plus years of accumulation produces a naturally diluted invited-share vs the younger heavily-prompted competitors.

## Company responsiveness to reviews

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Healthy · 8.3

Still the cleanest signal on the board. Every negative review on the App Store, Google Play and Trustpilot got a company reply this week, and overall reply coverage held at essentially 100% across all three. Whatever stays contested about how RiseGuide gathers its reviews, no unhappy customer is being left unanswered — a defensible, genuine strength that costs nothing to maintain and quietly underwrites the rest of the reputation story.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

Two-track operation: Trustpilot reply at 90.5%, Android Appbot 94%, but iOS reply rate 0%. Previous high score reflected Trustpilot only — once iOS visibility was added, the structural gap became the dominant signal.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 8

Trustpilot reply rate 63.5% — the lowest in cohort despite 120K reviews. Google Play reply rate is 100% including all negatives, suggesting selective engagement. iOS visibility gap is the only thing holding the score back further.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

Previously rated highest in cohort on Trustpilot's reply rate alone (87% on Trustpilot, 90% on negatives). Fuller picture now: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Largest single regression in the benchmark.

04

## Billing Transparency

3.2/10

**Headway** leads this dimension at **3.9/10**; RiseGuide sits at **3.2/10** (was 3.2 last week). All four brands held their dimension scores flat this week.

RiseGuide **3.2**Liven **2.9**Coursiv **3.1**Headway **3.9**

### Price disclosure

#### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.3

▼ -0.2

**Down from last week. The contradiction is the story this week: Google Play users grew happier overall, yet their pricing complaints nearly doubled — from seven to thirteen — at a punishing 2.2-star average. The price grievance has decoupled from general satisfaction, which means it's a specific checkout problem, not a mood. App Store pricing complaints eased in the other direction, but not enough to offset the Google Play jump.**

The contradiction this week is the story: Google Play users grew happier overall, yet their pricing complaints nearly doubled — from seven to thirteen — at a punishing 2.2-star average, while App Store pricing complaints eased in the other direction. The recurring grievance is unchanged and specific: a price users read as one-time that quietly becomes a higher recurring charge, described this week as 'a higher charge than the first' with 'no chance to cancel.' The relief on one store is cancelled by the jump on the other.

#### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

Worst pricing-disclosure exposure in the cohort — pricing complaints reached the largest cluster across all four brands. No homepage pricing; users must complete a quiz to see plans.

#### COURSIV

Critical · 3.5

Same quiz-funnel pattern as Liven: no upfront pricing, plans revealed at the end. Trial-to-renewal jump is the dominant friction in third-party complaints.

#### HEADWAY

LEADER

Mixed · 4.5

Second-worst pricing-complaint exposure despite mature operations. Website FAQ links to a pricing article rather than naming prices — a transparency gap hurting otherwise solid first impressions.

## Hidden / recurring charges

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 2.3

▲ +0.3

**Up from last week. The scorecard's worst signal finally moved the right way, if only slightly. Surprise-charge complaints eased on both stores this week — from twelve to eight on the App Store and seven to five on Google Play. It's real relief in the highest-anger topic on the board, though the reviews that remain are as furious as ever, averaging about one star. Fewer people are being blindsided; the ones who still are feel just as robbed.**

Still the worst signal on the entire scorecard — but for the first time in a while it ticked the right way. Surprise-charge complaints eased on both stores, from twelve to eight on the App Store and seven to five on Google Play. The reviews behind them stay brutal, averaging around one star: 'Subscription of 19.99, charge received of 49.99, even with automatic renewal disabled.' The volume eased; the fury per review didn't, and the charge-confirmation fix still hasn't shipped.

### LIVEN

Critical · 2

Largest billing-flow exposure in cohort. Auto-renewal complaints are widespread across Trustpilot and unmanaged channels. Trial-to-subscription transition isn't clearly signalled — structural, not noise.

### COURSIV

Critical · 2

Billing-adjacent complaints come from multiple vectors at once — payment surprises and deceptive-advertising complaints both active. BBB shows billing as the dominant complaint type historically.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Critical · 2.5

Significant billing-flow exposure despite mature operations. The 'HEADWAY APP IS A SCAM' Apple Communities thread persists, and unexpected weekly-premium charges after a 'free trial' remain the dominant Trustpilot 1-star theme.

## Ease of cancellation

### RISEGUIDE

#### Mixed · 4

The missing in-app cancel button is still the single mechanism tying every billing complaint together. This week's reviews repeat it almost word for word: 'no chance to cancel on Play Store,' 'I can't find a way to cancel the subscription.' The help guide still rescues whoever finds it, but it can't close the product gap that turns a billing surprise into a fraud accusation. Linking the guide from the in-app billing screen is the cheap half of the fix; a real in-app cancel path is the half that matters.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3.5

iOS support sentiment netted out negative, and combined with the iOS reply silence, users trying to cancel can't reach support on the largest store.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 3.5

A third-party site publishes a dedicated 'How to Cancel Coursiv' guide — a clear signal that the native flow has enough friction to create a third-party niche.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Watch · 6

Best cancellation infrastructure in cohort: published pre-renewal rule, multiple cancellation paths, no negative support-experience cluster.

## UI dark patterns

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 2.3

The pattern the company itself acknowledges — charging before a clearly stated renewal date, with no email receipt — kept generating the same reviews this week. A YouTube commenter spelled out the exact funnel: '\$19.99 for 4 weeks — if you try to leave without signing up it drops to \$15.99 — and then \$41.' The one steadying fact is that compliance flags stayed at a single routine billing query, not the fraud accusations that spiked earlier this summer. The perception that checkout is engineered against the user hasn't softened.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 2.5

Bug complaints and pricing-flow complaints overlap — the combined cluster is the broadest in cohort. Developer publicly acknowledged manipulative rating prompts but underlying upsell flows still flagged as aggressive.

### COURSIV

#### Critical · 2.5

Deceptive-advertising complaints are a distinctive cohort marker for Coursiv. The quiz-funnel pricing reveal is a textbook dark pattern that consistently surfaces in negative reviews.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Lower per-user incidence of dark-pattern complaints than peers. Apple Communities thread about misleading purchase flows persists, but the pattern is softer than what we see at Liven or Coursiv.

## Refund policy clarity & enforcement

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 3

Refunds still run on negotiation, not policy. This week a Google Play customer says they've been charged repeatedly on an app they stopped using and still 'can't find a way to cancel,' with no clear refund path offered. With no refund policy published on the website, every outcome depends on which agent happens to answer. A clear, public refund policy remains the cheapest credibility fix anywhere in this dimension — and its absence is what keeps every refund a fresh argument.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3

Claimed 30-day refund policy is enforced inconsistently — some refunds granted, others refused. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Public Money-Back Guarantee exists but requires completing most of the program to qualify — excluding most dissatisfied users. The team engages with negatives but enforces the restriction. Documented policy is a transparency floor.

### HEADWAY

#### Critical · 2.5

No public refund policy. Apple Communities and Trustpilot threads about refund refusals on full-year charges are active. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on iOS are structurally ignored.

05

Brand Trust & Legitimacy

4.5/10

▲ +0.1

Headway leads this dimension at 7.1/10; RiseGuide sits at 4.5/10 (was 4.4 last week). RiseGuide improved most this week (+0.1 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 4.5 ▲ +0.1

Liven 6.4

Coursiv 4.6

Headway 7.1

Company age & history

RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

Still young and still faceless. The company is roughly two years old and the app about six months, and the only public record of who runs it remains a name on business-registration filings. Time will harden into credibility on its own eventually, but the one lever available today — a real founder story attached to a real person — still hasn't been pulled, and nothing this week changed that.

LIVEN

Watch · 6

Around 4.5 years operating — the second-longest track record in cohort after Headway.

COURSIV

Critical · 3

Under a year operating, despite already having a six-figure review base. Youngest entity in cohort; review-base-to-age ratio is anomalous.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Six-plus years operating with a recent rebrand and publicly announced IPO plans. Most mature company in cohort by both operating history and corporate sophistication.

Legal & brand identity alignment

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.3

The acute legal-risk signal stayed calm for a second week. The compliance flags that spiked into blunt fraud accusations earlier this summer are still down to a single routine billing query, and no scam-flagging site cracked the top search results for the brand. It's not a clean bill of health — reviewers still reach for 'scam' when a charge surprises them — but the sharpest fraud signal has settled, and the criterion holds the ground it recovered last week.

LIVEN

Watch · 6

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand on billing and legal pages. Cyprus address publicly listed. Credibility signals in organic search results, no complaint domains ranking.

COURSIV

Mixed · 5

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand, but search results show a concerning share of complaint pages — a billing-vector concern. No credibility-domain anchors surface.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Corporate entity publicly disclosed on the homepage with US registered address. Legal pages comprehensive across terms, privacy, AI usage. Forbes appears as a credibility anchor; brand-owned domains dominate first-page results.

## Third-party recognition

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

▲ +0.3

**Up from last week. The independent voices outsiders trust most grew friendlier on both ends this week. Creator reviews climbed to 80% positive from 73%, and — the harder signal — their comment sections warmed alongside them, with negative comments falling to roughly one in ten. For months the story was enthusiastic creators over skeptical crowds; this week that gap narrowed instead of widening, and no new scam-framed video gained any traction.**

Independent coverage strengthened on both sides this week. Creator videos ran 80% positive, up from 73%, and — more tellingly — their comment sections warmed too, with negative comments dropping to about one in ten. The long-standing gap between enthusiastic creators and skeptical audiences narrowed rather than widened. A top review video has been seen over 62,000 times, and no new scam-framed video gained traction. The lone holdout is a persistent comment: 'Scam!!!!!! Beware!! I was charged but I could not access the app.'

### LIVEN

LEADER

Watch · 6

A Board of Health Professionals page lists 15+ named PhDs — a distinctive scientific-credibility signal. YouTube coverage is healthy with almost no complaint-framed videos. Crunchbase appears in search.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Listed on Tracxn and Crunchbase, with broad YouTube creator coverage. But organic search results skew complaint-heavy, and there's no editorial press coverage from Forbes, TechCrunch, or peer outlets.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

Strongest third-party recognition stack: Wikipedia, Endeavor entrepreneur backing, recurring trade press around IPO plans, and YouTube creator coverage unanimously positive.

# Leadership transparency

## RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

**Flat from last week. The longest-running flat line in the report, and still the biggest free win. No founder bio, no About page, no leadership presence anywhere in this week's search results — again — while reviewers openly reach for 'scam' when a charge surprises them. The absence of a named, photographed person to stand behind the product isn't a missing nicety; it's the void those accusations rush to fill.**

The longest-running flat line in the report, and still the biggest free win. No founder bio, no About page, no leadership presence anywhere in this week's search results — again — while reviewers openly accuse the brand of fraud. The absence of a named, photographed person to stand behind the product isn't a missing nicety; it's the void those accusations rush to fill. A short founder bio with a real photo remains the single highest score-per-effort fix anywhere in this scorecard.

## LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Founder publicly named, and an extensive list of health-professional advisors published by name and credential. Leadership identity transparent and verifiable.

## COURSIV

Critical · 3

No founders or executives publicly named anywhere — website, registry filings, or LinkedIn. Anonymous-corporate posture despite a very large customer base — a distinctive cohort outlier.

## HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Founder is public with extensive media presence — interviews, Endeavor profile, recurring press around the IPO. Strongest leadership transparency stack in cohort.

# Online presence consistency

RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6.3

▲ +0.3

RiseGuide won back a little of the search ground it lost last week. The results for 'riseguide' turned uniformly positive — the lone negative link from last week dropped out — and a third-party review aggregator that had been ranking, [riseguidereviews.com](#), fell out of the top results, leaving the brand's own pages and app-store listings to define the first impression. Where RiseGuide controls the message, the branding stays perfectly consistent across the website, both stores and Trustpilot.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Consistent branding across web, app stores, and Trustpilot. Official Health Professional Board page reinforces brand identity. Corporate address publicly displayed.

COURSIV

Watch · 6

Branding consistent across visible channels, but corporate and leadership data largely absent — undermines coherence at the trust layer. Organic search shows a concerning complaint-page share.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Wikipedia, Crunchbase, official About-us, press coverage, and store listings all reinforce the same brand and corporate identity. Search results contain the broadest unique-domain set in cohort.

## 3 IDEAS · NEXT WEEK

# Initiatives that would lift the score

**01 Publish an About-us page with founder bio**

**LIFTS:** LEADERSHIP TRANSPARENCY · 3.0 → ~5 · Single content page — one photo, four links. Ship by Friday.

Liven publicly names CEO Shahrooz Chowdhury + 15 PhD advisors — scores 7. Headway publicly names founder Anton Pavlovsky with press coverage — scores 8.

**How to ship**

- 1 Commission a clean headshot of Oleksandr Matsiuk + draft a 2-paragraph bio (background + why RiseGuide exists)
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/about](https://riseguide.com/about) with photo, bio, and a LinkedIn link
- 3 Link the page from the homepage footer and the App Store / Google Play developer pages

**02 Publish an explicit refund + cancellation policy**

**LIFTS:** REFUND POLICY 3.0 → 4+ · EASE OF CANCELLATION 4.3 → 5+ · Policy page + reply templates — text only, no engineering. Ship by Wednesday.

Headway's published 24-hour pre-renewal rule anchors their 6.0 score on cancellation (best in cohort). Coursiv's public Money-Back Guarantee anchors their 4.0 on refund policy.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a 1-page policy: **7-day no-questions refund + 24-hour pre-renewal cancel rule**
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/refunds](https://riseguide.com/refunds), link from the footer and every billing email
- 3 Update support reply templates + cross-link from in-app billing + store descriptions

**03 Publish a 'How your subscription works' explainer**

**LIFTS:** HIDDEN CHARGES 2.0 → 3+ · PRICE DISCLOSURE 5.0 → 6+ · Support article + email-template update. Text-only, no engineering, no funnel impact. Ship by Wednesday.

Reviewers report surprise at the first payment amount, but the underlying model (introductory discount, then renewal at full price) is industry-standard. The complaint is about clarity of communication, not the pricing itself.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a plain-English article: **introductory price + when full price kicks in + how to cancel**
- 2 Publish at [support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works](https://support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works), link from every billing email + App Store description
- 3 Update support reply templates to cite the article URL on every billing-surprise thread